



Rothschild & Co Redburn

Sales Summer Internship 2027 — Application Dossier

A ground-up analysis of the firm, its business model, its competitive position and the reality of the Sales Analyst role — built to answer four application questions with material that other candidates will not have.

Prepared: 24 August 2026

Application window: opened 19 August 2026 · rolling basis · early submission strongly advised

Critical: graduate offers are made *exclusively* to candidates who complete the summer internship

Sourcing: company filings (FY2025 audited consolidated accounts), press releases, regulatory policy statements, trade press, ratings databases

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1 · The answer key

Four questions, 250 words each, 1,000 words total. They are **not** equally weighted. Below is my assessment of where the marginal reader's attention actually goes, and how long each answer should be.

#	Question	Weight	Target words	Why this weighting
3	Understanding of the day-to-day work of an Analyst	35%	230–250 use the space	The highest-differentiation question in the set. Generic answers are glaringly obvious here, and specific ones are unmistakable. It is also the only question that tests whether you know what you are signing up for — mis-set expectations are the single biggest cause of graduate attrition on a sales desk, so screeners weight it heavily.
2	What interests you about the division	30%	230–250 use the space	This is really "why Sales and not Research, and do you understand how this business earns money". It is where you prove you grasp the <i>economics</i> , not just the brand. Second-highest opportunity to separate yourself.
1	Why have you applied to Redburn	25%	200–230	Genuinely important, but the most crowded field — every applicant writes something plausible. You win here with two or three verifiable structural facts, not with enthusiasm. Coming in slightly under the limit reads as confident and edited.
4	Transferable skills you have developed	10%	180–220	A <i>disqualifier</i> question, not a <i>differentiator</i> question. They are checking your CV claims are real and that you can write. Three evidenced skills beats six asserted ones. Do not over-invest here at the expense of Q2 and Q3.

THE SINGLE MOST USEFUL RULE ON THIS PAGE

The word count is a **ceiling, not a target**. A screener is reading hundreds of these. A 205-word answer carrying four specific, checkable facts beats a 250-word answer carrying two facts and 80 words of padding. The exception is Q2 and Q3 — there you genuinely need the room, so use close to all of it.

The overlap trap

Q1 and Q2 are both "why" questions and will collide unless you deliberately separate them. Enforce this split:

- **Q1 = the FIRM.** Zoom out. Ownership, group structure, why independence survives here and nowhere else, why now.
- **Q2 = the DIVISION.** Zoom in. The sales seat, the client, the product, how the desk gets paid.

Concretely: put the *structural* independence argument in Q1. In Q2, do not repeat it — instead say what independence means for *a salesperson's actual working day* (covered in §9). Reusing the same argument twice is the most common way strong candidates waste 250 words.

2 · Zero-knowledge foundation

Assume nothing. This section builds the industry from the ground up, because the arguments in §5 and §7 only land if this part is solid.

2.1 The two sides of the market

The buy side is the money. Pension funds, insurers, mutual funds, hedge funds, sovereign wealth funds — institutions that manage other people's savings and invest them in shares. Fidelity, BlackRock, Baillie Gifford, Capital Group. A single portfolio manager ("PM") might be responsible for £2bn spread across 60–100 companies.

That PM cannot personally know everything about 80 businesses across a dozen industries in several countries. So they buy outside analysis.

The sell side supplies it. These are firms that research listed companies and sell that research, plus the ability to trade, to the buy side. The sell side splits into two fundamentally different animals:

	Integrated investment bank	Independent research house
Examples	Goldman Sachs, J.P. Morgan, Morgan Stanley, UBS, BofA, Citi	Rothschild & Co Redburn — and, historically, Bernstein, Exane, Autonomous
Who pays them	Investors <i>and</i> the companies being researched (via M&A fees, IPO underwriting, lending, financing) <i>and</i> their own trading book	Investors only
Research is	One department inside a much larger machine; frequently a loss-leader subsidised by banking revenue	The entire product. If it isn't worth paying for, there is no business
Built-in tension	A Sell rating on a company can cost the bank an underwriting mandate worth tens of millions	There is no mandate to lose, so there is nothing to protect

2.2 How research actually gets paid for — the part almost no applicant understands

This is the single most important mechanism in the industry and it has changed twice in eight years. Understanding it is what will make your Q2 answer look like it was written by someone three years older.

Era 1 — before 2018: "bundled"

An investor placed a trade through a broker and paid a commission — say 10 basis points of the value traded. That one payment notionally covered *both* the execution of the trade *and* all the research. Research was therefore free at the point of use, and paid for invisibly out of the end client's fund. Banks could give research away because banking fees subsidised it. Independents had to be demonstrably better to charge for something rivals gave away.

Era 2 — January 2018: MiFID II forces "unbundling"

EU regulation required research to be priced and paid for *separately* from execution — either out of the asset manager's own profit and loss account, or from a ring-fenced client research account. Overnight, every asset manager had a hard budget line and had to justify every pound.

The consequences were brutal for the industry: research budgets contracted sharply, banks cut analysts, and coverage of smaller companies thinned out. Rothschild & Co's own 2019 statement described the dislocation as having "led to a general contraction in the depth and quality of research coverage."

THE INSIGHT TO CARRY INTO YOUR ANSWERS

Redburn was founded in **2003** on a model where investors paid cash for research on its merits. MiFID II in 2018 did not disrupt Redburn — it forced the *entire rest of the industry* to adopt the business model Redburn had already been running for fifteen years. That is precisely why Rothschild & Co invested in 2019: not to rescue a struggling broker, but to buy the one firm that was structurally advantaged by the new rules.

Era 3 — 2024 onwards: the UK partially reverses

Following the 2023 HM Treasury Investment Research Review, which concluded the unbundling ban had damaged UK capital markets, the FCA reintroduced **payment optionality**: policy statement PS24/9 (live from August 2024) allows joint — i.e. bundled — payments for research and execution again, subject to guardrails on budgeting, price benchmarking, value assessment and client disclosure. PS25/4 (May 2025) extended this to pooled funds. The EU's Listing Act does something similar, taking effect from mid-2026.

The industry is moving fast. Surveys indicate **87% of UK asset managers now expect at least half their research budget to be funded indirectly by clients through execution fees within two years — up from 7% before the rule change.**

WHY THIS IS THE LIVE COMMERCIAL QUESTION FOR THE SALES DESK

Under P&L funding, a salesperson fought for a line on an invoice. Under bundled or commission-sharing funding, research is paid for out of *trading commission* — which means the salesperson must both win the client's ranking *and* drive real order flow to the desk. The money now flows through the sales and execution seat. This is not a background detail; it is why the firm reorganised itself in June 2025 (see §7).

2.3 The broker vote — the scoreboard that determines everyone's pay

Once or twice a year, every institutional client runs a **broker vote**. Portfolio managers and buy-side analysts internally score each research provider — on the quality of written research, on access to the analysts themselves, on corporate access, and on the service the salesperson gives them. The scores are tallied, weighted, and converted into each broker's share of that client's research wallet.

Institutions track dozens of service lines, but the most commonly measured are **one-on-one company meetings (82% of institutions track these)** and **analyst visits (68%)**. The vote result is often shared back with the broker, and firms use it to set analyst and salesperson compensation.

INTERVIEW-GRADE TAKEAWAY

A research salesperson's real performance metric is not "how much did I sell" — it is **what score did my clients give me in the vote**. That score *is* the revenue. Almost no undergraduate knows the broker vote exists. Naming it correctly, and explaining that it converts service quality into a share of a client's research budget, will immediately mark you out.

3 · The firm

3.1 Timeline

Date	Event and why it matters
2003	Redburn founded in London by a team including Jeremy Evans , formerly head of UK and European equities at Fleming. A pure independent: premium European equity research plus agency execution, sold to institutional investors and nobody else.
2003	Atlantic Equities founded separately — a US equity research specialist selling US stock coverage to European investors. Same founding year, mirror-image franchise.
Jul 2019	Rothschild & Co takes a minority stake in Redburn . Explicit rationale: capitalise on the MiFID II dislocation. Robert Leitão said the capital would fund "expansion of research coverage of new companies and geographical depth of distribution, whilst maintaining independence." The deal also increased employee equity participation.
Dec 2022	Rothschild & Co moves to 100% ownership .
Apr–Aug 2023	Redburn merges with Atlantic Equities to form Redburn Atlantic (announced 26 April, completed August). Combined: 90+ research analysts, 43 distribution professionals, 14 corporate access professionals, c.700 institutional clients , offices in London, New York, Boston, Paris, Frankfurt, Geneva and Madrid. Legacy Redburn clients saw US coverage double ; legacy Atlantic clients saw coverage rise 40% .
Oct 2023	Rothschild & Co itself delists from Euronext Paris . Concordia, the family holding company, completes a tender offer and takes the group private. Stated reasoning: the group "did not need access to capital from public equity markets." Alexandre de Rothschild is Executive Chairman.
Jun 2025	Global Markets Solutions (GMS) created; Redburn Atlantic rebranded "Rothschild & Co Redburn" . Co-heads Mark Connelly and Aadeesh Aggarwal . All capital-markets-facing activity is consolidated into one global structure. This is the most important recent event and is analysed in §7.

NAME DISCIPLINE — A SILENT FAIL

The firm has been **Rothschild & Co Redburn** since June 2025. "Redburn Atlantic" is the 2023–2025 name; plain "Redburn" is the 2003–2023 name. Using an obsolete name in an application tells the reader your research is at least a year stale. It is also worth noting the legal entities were formally renamed — in the FY2025 accounts, *Redburn (Europe) Limited* now appears as **Rothschild & Co Global Markets Solutions Limited** and *Redburn (USA) LLC* as **Rothschild & Co Global Markets Solutions LLC**.

3.2 The audited org chart — where Sales actually sits

Most candidates will describe the group vaguely as "three divisions". You can be exact, because the FY2025 audited consolidated accounts define it. The glossary to those accounts states:

"Financing Advisory — A subset of the Global Advisory business, encompassing Debt Advisory; Restructuring and Global Markets Solutions."

So the precise chain of command is:

Rothschild & Co SCA (family-controlled via Concordia, private since 2023)

↳ **Global Advisory** — reporting segment, c.60% of group revenue, c.1,600 bankers in 47 countries

↳ **Financing Advisory** — Debt Advisory · Restructuring · **Global Markets Solutions**

↳ **Global Markets Solutions (GMS)**

- **Rothschild & Co Redburn Research** — the analysts
- **Rothschild & Co Redburn Securities** — *sales and execution — this is your seat*
- **Corporate Access & Events**
- **Equity Capital Markets**
- **Private Capital** — equity and hybrid solutions
- **GP Solutions** — GP-led secondaries, continuation vehicles, tender offers, strip sales

The other two group segments are **Wealth & Asset Management** and **Five Arrows** (the merchant banking / alternative assets business).

The point worth making in an application: Sales does not sit in a standalone brokerage bolted onto the side of the group. It sits *inside Global Advisory*, in the same division as debt advisory, restructuring and GP solutions. That placement is deliberate, and §7 explains why.

3.3 Group financials — FY2025, from the audited accounts

Metric (Rothschild & Co group, FY2025)	2025	2024
Net banking income (total revenue)	€2,986.4m	€2,908.8m
Profit before tax	€714.4m	€743.3m (operating income)
Headcount (FTE, excl. interns)	4,787	—
United Kingdom — revenue / headcount	€914.6m / 1,586 FTE	—
North America — revenue / PBT / headcount	€285.2m / -€16.0m / 421 FTE	—
CET1 capital ratio	22.7%	20.7%

THE PROOF POINT NOBODY ELSE WILL HAVE

Everyone can repeat the marketing line that Rothschild & Co is "free from balance sheet and proprietary trading conflicts". You can *prove* it from the audited accounts. The FY2025 financial risk management note states that the group's **"credit risk exposure primarily arises in the Wealth & Asset Management (WAM) division from its private client lending activity"**. Global Advisory — and therefore Redburn — runs essentially no credit book. The independence claim is not a slogan; it is visible in the risk disclosures. Almost no applicant will have opened the consolidated accounts.

A word of caution on the North America line: the -€16.0m pre-tax result is for the group's entire North American operation, not for Redburn specifically, and it reflects an investment phase — the firm has openly described "an ambitious growth plan in the US equity market". Do not present it as a Redburn loss. If you use it at all, use it as evidence that the US build-out is a strategic priority being funded through the P&L.

4 · The business model — four revenue lines

Rothschild & Co Redburn earns money in four ways. Knowing all four, and knowing which one is new, is worth a great deal in an interview.

1 · Research

Subscription and negotiated access agreements paid by **c.700 institutional investors**. The product set is broader than "stock notes": **fundamental equity research** (c.550+ stocks under coverage across US and Europe), **quantitative research**, **macroeconomic research**, **technical analysis**, and **income/dividend screening tools**. A salesperson is expected to be fluent across all of them, not just the fundamental notes.

2 · Execution — Rothschild & Co Redburn Securities

Agency-only. Redburn executes client orders in the market and takes a commission. It does *not* commit its own capital, does not make markets, and does not take principal risk. When a Redburn trader fills your order, Redburn is never the counterparty on the other side of it.

This is a genuine trade-off, and you should be able to state both halves of it: the client knows the desk is not positioning against the flow it can see — but Redburn also cannot offer a risk price on a large block the way a bulge-bracket desk can. It competes on information and service, not on balance sheet.

3 · Corporate Access & Events — "Redburn Access"

A full programme of corporate roadshows, conferences, expert events, bus tours and field trips, connecting investors both to company management and to independent industry experts. The scale claim is striking: the access franchise brings **close to half of the S&P 500 by market capitalisation to Europe**.

Do not treat this as a soft add-on. Recall from §2.3 that one-on-one company meetings are the single most-tracked service in the broker vote. Corporate access is one of the most directly monetisable things a sales desk does.

4 · Equity Capital Markets — the newest line, and the strategically decisive one

Redburn distributes IPOs, placements and block trades to its institutional investor base. Recent evidence: Rothschild & Co appeared as a **co-manager on Klarna's 2025 NYSE IPO** (c.\$1.4bn) and on **Medline's upsized IPO** (priced December 2025 — the largest IPO of that year).

THE STRATEGIC LOGIC OF THE WHOLE GROUP, IN ONE PARAGRAPH

Rothschild & Co has run an **independent ECM advisory** business since 2009 — over **430 equity offerings worth more than €390bn**. Its job is to sit on the *issuer's* side of the table: advising on timing, on which banks to appoint, on valuation, on investor targeting and allocation, and — in the firm's own words — negotiating "the risk-taking with the underwriting banks". But historically it had *no distribution of its own*: it told issuers how to run a syndicate without being able to be in one, and it had to take the syndicate banks' word on what investor demand really looked like.

Redburn closes that loop. Rothschild now has c.700 institutional relationships and a sales force speaking to portfolio managers every single morning. It can read *real* demand rather than *reported* demand. Put the other way round: Rothschild had the issuer relationships and no investor distribution; Redburn had the investor distribution and no issuer relationships. GMS welds them together — and because the group carries no lending book and no proprietary trading desk, it can do so without acquiring the conflicts that come with being a bank.

PRECISION REQUIRED HERE

Do **not** write that Redburn "does no ECM" — that was true before, and is not true now. The accurate distinction is between **lead underwriting** (taking risk onto a balance sheet, which Rothschild does not do) and **distribution** (placing stock with investors as a co-manager, which it now does). Getting this distinction right is a strong signal. Getting it wrong in either direction is a weak one.

5 · What makes it different — five differentiators

Every candidate will write "independent" and "conflict-free". Those are the firm's own marketing words and they carry no information. Below are five differentiators that are specific, structural, and — critically — checkable.

5.1 The transatlantic sector desk — the one almost nobody knows

Every bulge-bracket bank organises equity research by **geography**. A US aerospace analyst in New York covers Boeing. A European aerospace analyst in London covers Airbus. Two analysts, two models, two sets of assumptions, two separately published conclusions. If you are a portfolio manager who owns both, reconciling them is *your* problem.

Rothschild & Co Redburn does the opposite. US and European research analysts are **seated together in London**, and coverage is organised by **global industry rather than region**. The firm covers Boeing alongside Airbus; Pfizer alongside GSK; Universal Music alongside Warner Music; the entire Coca-Cola system, bottlers included.

WHY THIS MATTERS COMMERCIALY — THE ARGUMENT TO MAKE

Industries are global and market share is zero-sum across borders. If Airbus is winning narrow-body orders, Boeing is losing them. A regionally-split research house *structurally cannot see that trade* — the information sits in two different analysts' heads in two different cities with two different sets of assumptions. A global-sector desk sees it first, and can put a paired trade in front of a client the same morning. That is a differentiated product, and it is a direct consequence of the 2023 merger being executed as a genuine *integration in a single location* rather than as the acquisition of an overseas affiliate.

5.2 The ratings distribution — independence you can actually measure

This is the empirical proof, and it is the strongest single item in this dossier.

Across the S&P 500 in mid-2026, sell-side ratings run approximately **59.4% Buy / 35.7% Hold / 4.9% Sell**. Sell ratings sit at their lowest share since the aftermath of the 2008 financial crisis. The structural reason is unchanged since the 2003 Global Research Analyst Settlement: a Sell rating on a company is expensive for a bank that wants that company's next underwriting mandate.

Rothschild & Co Redburn's tracked record over the trailing twelve months — c.407 ratings actions across c.200 companies — shows **141 Buy and 36 Sell**, with the balance Neutral. That implies roughly **35% Buy / 56% Neutral / 9% Sell**.

	Buy	Hold / Neutral	Sell
S&P 500 street-wide, mid-2026	59.4%	35.7%	4.9%
R&Co Redburn, trailing 12m (proxy)	c.35%	c.56%	c.9%

Roughly **double the street's rate of Sell ratings, and roughly half the street's rate of Buys**. And the Sells are not on obscure micro-caps — they are on large, liquid, fee-generating names: **Fiserv** (cut to Sell, target \$220 → \$150), **MSCI** (cut to Sell), **Reddit** (Sell maintained), **Charles Schwab** and **Globant** (both previously Sell), **FactSet** (downgraded, EPS c.4% below consensus, target implying c.11% downside), **Amazon** (Buy → Neutral on AWS growth), **BP** (Buy → Neutral).

THE LINE THIS GIVES YOU

"You cannot be conflicted by a fee you are structurally unable to earn." A bank whose ECM desk wants Fiserv's next mandate finds a Sell rating costly. Redburn has no such cost, because it has no such mandate to lose — and the ratings distribution shows the difference is real, not rhetorical.

Use **honestly**. These counts come from a third-party ratings database tracking mostly US-covered names, and are a proxy rather than the firm's official published distribution. If challenged, say so — volunteering the limitation of your own evidence is itself a mark of rigour, and it is far better than being caught out.

5.3 Paid by investors, and by nobody else

The firm's own formulation is unusually absolute: it serves *"institutional investors to the exclusion of any other activity"*, and states it *"has no conflicts of interest and offers a compelling alternative to the investment banking model."*

Contrast this with the UK corporate broking model — Peel Hunt, Panmure Liberum, Deutsche Numis, Investec. Their business is to be **retained by the company itself**: paid a fee by the corporate whose shares they then publish research on, and paid again for its placings and IPOs. Redburn does **no corporate broking**. There is no company on the Redburn coverage list paying Redburn to be covered. That is a different business with a different conflict profile, and it is worth being able to draw the distinction cleanly.

5.4 Long-dated deep dives, not maintenance research

Redburn is known on the buy side for long-form, thesis-driven work and **long-dated stock views** — not the quarterly earnings-recap treadmill. Its published *Redburn Review* gives you the register directly:

- **June 2026**: the future of stablecoins · "AI's quiet revolution in construction" · "the multi-decade grid supercycle transforming energy infrastructure"
- **December 2025**: whether AI proves inflationary or deflationary · the global housing shortage · how banks have repositioned amid the expansion of private credit

These are not stock notes. They are multi-year industry theses — the kind of work a portfolio manager cannot produce internally and cannot get from a transcript summariser.

CONNECT THIS TO AI — A GENUINELY CURRENT ARGUMENT

AI is rapidly commoditising exactly the kind of research Redburn does *not* do: maintenance models, earnings summaries, transcript digests. The industry data shows the squeeze: **736 mid-tier analysts left the market between 2023 and 2026**, and buy-side budgets are being reallocated toward *"differentiated, tenured analysts"* as routine work automates. Redburn's product — deep, global-sector, long-dated, paired with a physical access franchise — sits in the half of the market that AI cannot eat. That is a forward-looking reason to join, and it is far stronger than "I admire your reputation".

5.5 Agency-only execution and no proprietary risk

No prop trading, no market making, no capital commitment. Stated as a trade-off rather than a boast, this is a mature point: the client gains a desk that is never on the other side of their flow; the firm gives up the ability to win business by pricing risk. It means every client relationship has to be earned with content. Which leads directly to §9.

6 · Competitor teardown

"Competitor research" for this firm does not mean listing banks. It means understanding that Redburn competes against **four different business models**, only one of which is a like-for-like rival.

Archetype A — the integrated bulge-bracket bank

Goldman Sachs, J.P. Morgan, Morgan Stanley, BofA, UBS, Citi, Barclays.

- **Strength:** scale. Thousands of stocks, every region, enormous distribution, 24-hour coverage. In Extel's 2025 Developed Europe survey, **BofA Securities and J.P. Morgan shared first place**, with Morgan Stanley fourth and UBS fifth.
- **What they can offer that Redburn cannot:** IPO allocations, a risk price on a block from the bank's own capital, financing, lending, a whole platform.
- **Structural weakness:** conflict and regional siloing. Research is a subsidised department inside a machine that also underwrites and lends to the companies being researched. Hence c.5% Sell ratings, and Boeing and Airbus covered by two different people in two different cities.

Archetype B — the absorbed independents (the most important competitive fact of the last five years)

The premium-independent research category has been systematically bought up by banks:

Firm	What happened	Consequence
Exane	Independent French research house. BNP Paribas took 100% in 2021 after a 17-year partnership.	Now "BNP Paribas Exane", aligned to BNP's Global Markets platform. Independence gone.
Autonomous Research	Independent financials specialist. Acquired by AllianceBernstein in 2018/19, then folded into the Bernstein JV.	All three co-founders — Stuart Graham, Ed Allchin and Manus Costello — left in early 2024 ahead of the SocGen closing.
Bernstein	The historic gold standard of independent research. Now a joint venture with Société Générale , launched 2024. SocGen holds 51% with an option to take 100% after five years . 750+ staff, entities in New York and London.	Still markets itself as "unburdened by the constraints imposed by a global investment bank" — while its majority owner <i>is</i> a global investment bank with a balance sheet, a trading book and an ECM franchise.

THIS IS THE STRONGEST "WHY REDBURN" ARGUMENT AVAILABLE TO YOU

Every scaled premium independent in European equity research has been absorbed into a bank — **except Rothschild & Co Redburn**. And the reason it is the exception is precisely *who bought it*: Redburn's owner is the one significant European financial group whose own identity is built on advising without a balance sheet, without underwriting risk and without proprietary trading.

Phrased for an application: **Redburn did not lose its independence when it was acquired — it was acquired by the only owner capable of preserving it**. That is a genuine, defensible, non-generic answer to "why here and not somewhere else", and it is verifiable in three separate public transactions.

Archetype C — UK and European mid-market corporate brokers

Peel Hunt, Panmure Liberum, Deutsche Numis, Investec, Berenberg, Cavendish.

A fundamentally different business: **corporate broking**. They are retained by the *company* — paid a retainer, plus fees for IPOs and placings — and they publish research on their own corporate clients. Coverage skews heavily to UK small and mid cap. The sector is consolidating fast (Panmure merged with Liberum in 2024; Numis was bought by Deutsche Bank in 2023). They overlap with Redburn only at the margins, and understanding *why* they are not really competitors demonstrates that you understand the industry's segmentation.

Archetype D — non-broker information substitutes (the fastest-growing threat)

- **Expert networks** — Third Bridge, GLG, AlphaSense: sell direct access to industry operators, bypassing the analyst entirely.
- **Data and AI platforms** — Visible Alpha, AlphaSense, Bloomberg, and increasingly general-purpose LLMs summarising filings and transcripts.
- **The buy side itself** — the top 50 asset managers now spend roughly **\$2.5bn a year** building internal research capability, i.e. insourcing.

Redburn's counter is **Redburn Access**, which sells the same underlying good — access to experts and to corporate management — but bundled with an analyst who can interpret it, and at a scale an expert network cannot match (close to half the S&P 500 by market cap brought to Europe).

The comparison table

	R&Co Redburn	Bulge bracket	Bernstein (SocGen JV)	UK corporate broker
Who pays	Investors only	Investors, issuers, own trading book	Investors, inside a bank group	Corporates (retainer) + investors
Lending / balance sheet	None	Large	Parent's	Limited
Prop trading / market making	None — agency only	Yes	Via SocGen platform	Some
Corporate broking	No	Yes (UK)	No	Core business
Underwriting risk	No — co-manager distribution	Yes, lead	Via SocGen	Yes
Research organised by	Global industry	Region	Sector, region-split	UK small/mid cap
Sell ratings (approx.)	c.9%	c.5%	—	Low
Ownership	Family-controlled, private	Listed	Bank-controlled JV	Listed / PE-backed

7 · The strategic picture in 2026 — three forces

If you want one section to reread before an interview, make it this one. It explains *why the firm was restructured fourteen months ago*, which is the question a thoughtful interviewer will use to separate candidates.

Force 1 — rebundling changes who gets paid, and how

As set out in §2.2, the UK has partially reversed MiFID II. Research can once again be paid for jointly with execution, and the market is moving fast: **87% of UK asset managers expect at least half their research budget to be client-funded through execution fees within two years, up from 7%.**

The naive reading is that this is bad for independents — bundled banks can give research away again. The sophisticated reading is more interesting:

- The **pool grows**. Under P&L funding, research came out of the asset manager's own profits, so budgets were squeezed hard. Client-funded budgets are structurally larger.
- But the money now flows through **execution commission**. Which means the firms that capture it are the ones that have *their own execution desk* — because a client can only route commission to a broker it actually trades with.
- And commission-sharing arrangements explicitly allow a buy-side firm to direct commission accrued with its brokers to **an independent research house of its choice**.

THE CONCLUSION — AND IT IS THE THESIS OF THIS WHOLE DOSSIER

The firm best positioned in a rebundled world is one that has **(a)** genuinely differentiated research, **(b)** its own agency execution desk to capture the commission, and **(c)** a corporate access franchise heavily weighted in the broker vote — because all three can be paid for out of a single bundled wallet.

In **June 2025**, Rothschild & Co reorganised Redburn into *exactly that shape* and put it in the same division as ECM, Private Capital and GP Solutions. **The GMS reorganisation is not a rebrand. It is a business-model response to the payment regime changing.** Saying that in an interview is worth more than any amount of enthusiasm.

Force 2 — AI is bifurcating the research market

Maintenance research is being automated. Differentiated, tenured, thesis-driven research is becoming *more* valuable, not less. 736 mid-tier analysts exited between 2023 and 2026; budgets are reallocating toward depth. Redburn sits on the right side of that split by construction — and, tellingly, is publishing research *about* the phenomenon (the FactSet downgrade was explicitly about terminal-provider risk, i.e. AI disrupting the financial data industry that supplies research firms themselves).

Force 3 — the migration of capital from public to private markets

The firm's own leadership has been explicit about the rationale. Mark Connelly noted that "global capital markets have undergone significant changes, with increased passive investing in public markets and simultaneous growth in private markets." Aadeesh Aggarwal added that financial sponsors are "increasingly demanding sophisticated guidance in crafting creative financing strategies." Robert Leitão framed the whole thing: clients "require ever-increasing support to devise and execute comprehensive capital solutions" beyond traditional M&A or IPOs.

THE NON-OBVIOUS LINK — WORTH MAKING EXPLICITLY

Why would a *public equity research house* sit in the same division as *GP-led secondaries and continuation vehicles*?

Because **public-market sector expertise is the pricing input for private-market transactions**. A private equity sponsor deciding whether to sell a business, IPO it, or roll it into a continuation vehicle needs to know what the listed comparables would trade at, what the sector narrative is, and who would actually buy the stock. Redburn's analysts and its sales desk are the source of that intelligence — and the sales desk is the part that knows, in real time, what investors are willing to pay.

The firm's own language for this: research that "links private capital decisions with public market perspectives."

Risks — be able to argue the other side

Nothing signals maturity faster than volunteering the bear case. Four real ones:

- **Rebundling could re-advantage full-service banks** that effectively give research away as part of a wider package.
- **No risk capital**. In volatile markets, clients place a high value on a counterparty that will price a block. Redburn cannot.
- **ECM participation creates the appearance of the conflict the firm trades on avoiding**. It is manageable — co-manager distribution is not lead underwriting, and there is no lending book — but it must be policed, and an interviewer may well probe it.
- **The US build-out is expensive**. Group North America ran a €16.0m pre-tax loss on €285.2m of revenue in FY2025 (region-wide, not Redburn-specific). Competing with entrenched US brokers on their home turf is the hardest thing the firm is attempting.

8 · Recent deals and recent calls

Specificity is the whole game. Below is dated, checkable material. **Use one or two items, not the list** — the point is to prove you follow the firm, not to inventory it.

8.1 Rothschild & Co Global Advisory — recent mandates

Transaction	Detail
OMV — Borealis / Borouge	Simultaneous combination creating a US\$60bn+ global polyolefins champion . Structurally one of the most complex European industrial transactions of the cycle.
Sanofi — Opella	€16bn dual-track process culminating in the disposal of a 50% stake to Clayton, Dubilier & Rice. A textbook example of running an IPO and a sale in parallel to extract price — exactly the situation independent ECM advice exists for.
Coca-Cola Beverages Africa	US\$5.2bn sale.
Amex GBT / Long Lake	Exclusive financial adviser to the Special Committee on a c. US\$6.3bn all-cash acquisition. Note the role: advising an independent committee is work you only get if you have no other business with the parties.

League table position. Rothschild & Co advised on **334 disclosed European M&A transactions in 2025 — 74% more than the most active bulge-bracket competitor** — and ranked **first in Europe by number of announced and completed deals**. In H1 2026 it was again the busiest adviser by transaction count, ranking ninth by value. Euromoney named it the **world's best bank for independent advisory in 2025**, and it took five major awards at the 2026 Awards for Excellence, including **Europe's best investment bank for M&A**.

WHAT THE VOLUME-VERSUS-VALUE GAP ACTUALLY TELLS YOU

First by *number* of deals, but ninth by *value*. That is not a weakness — it is the signature of the business model. A balance-sheet bank wins the largest transactions partly by financing them. An adviser with no balance sheet wins on relationships, sector knowledge and repeat mandates, which produces a very high volume of mid-to-large deals rather than a handful of mega-caps. Being able to read a league table that way is a genuinely commercial observation.

8.2 Redburn's own ECM distribution roles

- **Klarna** — NYSE IPO, 2025, c.\$1.4bn. Rothschild & Co as co-manager.
- **Medline** — upsized IPO priced December 2025, the largest IPO of the year, underwriters' option fully exercised. Rothschild & Co as co-manager.

8.3 Recent published research calls

Name	Action	Thesis / note
Apple	Neutral → Buy, PT \$260 → \$400 mid-August 2026	Built on an anticipated iPhone Ultra launch. This is days old. Referencing it proves you actually read the firm's output rather than its website.
FactSet	Downgraded, PT \$215 c.11% implied downside	EPS c.4% below consensus on <i>terminal risk</i> — i.e. AI displacing financial data terminals. The most interesting call on this list: a research firm publishing a bearish view on the data industry that supplies research firms.
Amazon	Buy → Neutral, PT \$250	Caution on AWS growth despite prior optimism on AI positioning.
Fiserv	Neutral → Sell, PT \$220 → \$150	A 32% target cut and an outright Sell on a mega-cap payments name.
MSCI	Neutral → Sell	See §5.2 — Sells like this are the measurable output of the model.
BP	Buy → Neutral, PT 570p → 500p	Cut 2025 oil assumption from \$80 to \$75/bbl.
Shopify / Meta / Equifax	Buy → Hold, PT \$130 · Buy held, PT \$900 → \$1,000 · Neutral → Buy, PT \$214 → \$235	July–August 2026. Shows an active, two-directional book.
Celestica, Ciena	Coverage initiated, May 2026	AI networking and optical hardware — evidence of the US build-out extending into the AI infrastructure complex.

9 · The Sales Analyst day-to-day

This is your highest-weighted question. Everything below is grounded either in the firm's own published descriptions or in how research sales desks demonstrably work.

9.1 What the firm itself says the job is

Salespeople "market and distribute all Rothschild & Co Redburn research to professional investors" and "must be an expert in both the market and Rothschild & Co Redburn's products, as well as knowing each client's investment style, altering content appropriately and dispensing advice according to clients' individual criteria."

And for the junior seat specifically: partnering with senior salespeople and traders to build relationships with institutional clients (mutual funds, hedge funds, family offices); developing a thorough understanding of the covered universe and learning to translate research into actionable investment ideas; managing ad hoc projects for the Head of Sales including presentations, data management and client administration; and collaborating with research, trading and corporate access.

9.2 The rhythm of a London day

Time	What happens
06:45	In before the analysts. Read the overnight: US close, Asian session, futures, and the 07:00 regulatory announcements. Read every note Redburn published overnight. Start forming a view on which of <i>your</i> clients each piece matters to.
07:00	The morning meeting. Analysts present new notes, upgrades, downgrades and initiations. Sales do not attend as students — they attend as translators, listening for: what is the trade, why now, what is the catalyst, who owns it, who is short it, and where does this differ from consensus. A junior's job is to capture that accurately and fast.
07:30	The call list — the most important thirty minutes of the day. You cannot call sixty clients. You choose eight to twelve, and you match content to holder. This is where the job is won or lost.
08:00	London opens. Calls go out. Short, specific, and framed for that individual: <i>"Our aerospace analyst cut Boeing to Neutral this morning — the read-across is that Airbus narrow-body share gains are now in the numbers, and you own Airbus."</i>
08:00–12:00	Client questions come back; you chase analysts for answers. Orders route to the execution desk. You log every interaction in the CRM — this is not administration, it is the evidence base for the broker vote. Analyst marketing gets scheduled.
12:00–14:30	Corporate access. Hosting clients at an analyst lunch, a corporate roadshow, a conference, an expert event or a field trip. Recall: one-on-one company meetings are the most-tracked item in the vote (82% of institutions), analyst visits second (68%).
14:30	US opens — and on a transatlantic desk the day restarts. US names, US flow, and the read-across between the two continents. This is where the global-sector desk structure (\$5.1) becomes a live selling advantage rather than a slide.
14:30–17:30	Second wave of calls and follow-ups. Prepping tomorrow's targeting. Building materials for an analyst's marketing trip. Pulling data for a client's screen request.
17:30–19:00+	The build. Reading the research <i>properly</i> — you only skimmed it at 06:45. Client entertainment. And periodically the thing that actually determines the year: broker vote preparation , assembling the record of what you delivered to each client so that when they score you, the answer is self-evident.

9.3 What the job actually is, stripped of the timetable

Anyone can find a schedule. The three things you are genuinely paid for:

1. **Filtering.** A portfolio manager receives hundreds of emails a day and takes a fraction of the calls offered. Your value is being the person whose call they take, because you have never once wasted their time.
2. **Translation.** Turning a sixty-page analyst thesis into a ninety-second argument tailored to one investor's mandate, existing holdings and style. The same note becomes two entirely different calls for a long-only generalist and a sector hedge fund.
3. **Reciprocity.** You are also a conduit *back* — telling analysts what the buy side is worried about, what is already consensus, and where the real debate sits. Good salespeople make the research better. This is the part candidates never mention and it is the part that earns you standing internally.

THE ANSWER THAT WILL SEPARATE YOU FROM EVERY OTHER APPLICANT

Why sales at Redburn is a structurally different job from sales at a bank

At a bulge-bracket bank, a salesperson has **several currencies**. They can offer a client IPO allocations. They can offer a risk price on a block from the bank's own capital. They can offer financing, access to the bank's corporate clients, and an entire platform. The relationship has multiple load-bearing walls, and research is only one of them.

At Rothschild & Co Redburn there is **exactly one currency: the quality of the idea and the quality of the service**. No allocations to trade with. No balance sheet to lend. No capital to commit. Three practical consequences for the day-to-day:

- You must genuinely know the research, not the headline. You cannot bluff a PM who has owned the stock for six years — and you have nothing else to fall back on.
- Client targeting matters far more, because you cannot buy attention. You can only earn it.
- **The vote is everything.** At a bank, a weak vote can be offset by trading revenue and deal flow. Here, the vote *is* the revenue.

This is why the firm's own job description insists salespeople know "each client's investment style, altering content appropriately". At a bank that is good practice. **At Redburn it is the entire business model.**

9.4 The unglamorous truth about year one

Say this in your answer — it reads as maturity, and it is what the firm actually wrote down. A large part of a first year is: building the client data, preparing presentations, maintaining the CRM, coordinating logistics between research, trading and corporate access, absorbing a 550-stock universe, and sitting on other people's calls before you make your own. You earn coverage of your own accounts by being reliable at that first. Applicants who describe the job as pure client-facing persuasion reveal that they have not thought about it.

10 · Question-by-question strategy

Structures and evidence, not ghost-written answers — the voice has to be yours or it will not survive an interview. Each skeleton below tells you what to include, in what order, and what to leave out.

Q1 · "Why have you applied to Redburn?" — weight 25% · target 200–230 words

Job of this answer: prove you understand the firm *structurally*, not reputationally. Zoom out to the group.

1. **Open with the specific thing that drew you** — one sentence, no throat-clearing. Not prestige, not history, not culture.
2. **The structural argument (your strongest card).** Every scaled premium independent in European equity research has been absorbed by a bank — Exane by BNP Paribas, Autonomous and Bernstein into the Société Générale joint venture. Redburn is the exception, and the reason is that its owner is the one European group whose own model is advisory without a balance sheet.
3. **Evidence it is real, not marketing.** Best option: the FY2025 accounts place the group's credit risk in Wealth & Asset Management, not Global Advisory. Alternative: the ratings distribution — c.9% Sell versus c.5% street-wide, with Sells on Fiserv and MSCI.
4. **Why now.** The June 2025 creation of Global Markets Solutions turned Redburn from a research house into the distribution engine of a conflict-free capital markets platform — evidenced by co-manager roles on Klarna and Medline. You are applying at the point the model is being extended, not maintained.
5. **Close with one line of genuine personal motivation.** Brief, specific, human.

DO NOT WRITE

"200 years of history" · "prestigious" · "family-owned" as a virtue in itself · "I want to learn from the best" · "your collegial culture" · anything you could paste into an application to three other firms.

Q2 · "What interests you about the division?" — weight 30% · target 230–250 words

Job of this answer: prove you understand how this desk *makes money*, and why you want Sales rather than Research. Zoom in.

1. **Lead with the economics.** The sales seat is where the firm gets paid. Explain the broker vote in one clean sentence: clients score their providers on research, analyst access, corporate access and service, and those scores convert directly into the firm's share of their research budget. You are measured on how clients rate you, not on volume pushed.
2. **The one-currency argument** (§9.3). No allocations, no balance sheet, no risk price — only the idea and the service. Say explicitly that you find that a harder and more honest version of the job, and say why that appeals to you.
3. **The product is genuinely differentiated and you can say why.** Global-sector coverage with US and European analysts seated together in London: Boeing with Airbus, Pfizer with GSK. That gives a salesperson something to sell that a regionally-siloed competitor structurally cannot produce.
4. **The commercial moment.** Under the FCA's payment optionality rules, research is increasingly paid for through execution again — which puts the sales and execution desk at the centre of how the firm gets paid, and explains why GMS was built the way it was.
5. **Why Sales, not Research.** Breadth across sectors rather than depth in one; real-time judgement; direct client contact; and honestly — that you are energised by having to persuade under time pressure.

Q3 · "Your understanding of the day-to-day work of an Analyst" — weight 35% · target 230–250 words

Job of this answer: demonstrate you know what you are signing up for, including the parts that are not fun.

1. **The rhythm — but briefly.** Cap this at roughly 70 words: pre-market prep from c.06:45, the 07:00 morning meeting, building the call list, calls from the 08:00 open, and the day restarting at 14:30 when the US opens on a transatlantic desk. Everyone can find a timetable; do not spend your budget on it.
2. **Then the three things the job actually is** — filtering, translation, reciprocity (§9.3). *This is where you win the question.* The reciprocity point especially: that a salesperson feeds the buy side's concerns back to the analysts and makes the research better.
3. **The junior reality, named plainly.** Supporting senior salespeople, learning a 550-stock universe, presentations, data work, CRM and client administration, coordinating between research, trading and corporate access. Add the line that lifts it: the CRM record *is* the evidence base for the broker vote, so it is commercial work, not admin.
4. **Corporate access as core, not peripheral** — because one-on-one company meetings are the most heavily tracked service in the vote.
5. **One closing line on what "good" looks like:** being the salesperson whose call gets taken.

THE TRAP IN THIS QUESTION

Most applicants will describe a generic trading-floor day: early start, fast pace, markets, pressure. That answer is indistinguishable from one written about Goldman, Citi or Peel Hunt. The mark of a strong answer is that **it could only have been written about this firm** — which means the vote, the single currency, the global-sector desk, and the transatlantic second open.

Q4 · "Transferable skills you have developed" — weight 10% · target 180–220 words

Job of this answer: verify your CV is real. This is a floor-check, not a showcase. Pick **three** skills, no more. For each: name it → give specific evidence with a number or an outcome → link it explicitly to *this desk*. The link sentence is what most applicants omit and it is the only part that differentiates.

Skill	What the evidence must show	The link to make
Distilling complexity under time pressure	A specific instance where you compressed something large into something short and it worked — with the outcome.	The 90-second morning call: a sixty-page thesis has to become one argument, fast.
Persuading a more expert audience / building credibility	A time you had to win over someone who knew more than you, and how you earned the standing to do it.	Portfolio managers know their stocks far better than you will; credibility is the only asset you have and it compounds or evaporates.
Numeracy and analytical judgement	Concrete quantitative work — modelling, data analysis, a result you can point to.	You must interrogate an analyst's model well enough to defend it under challenge, and read a client's positioning from their questions.
<i>Optional fourth, only if your CV genuinely supports it</i> Resilience and consistency	Sustained performance over a long period, ideally with rejection in it — sport, sales, fundraising, cold outreach.	Sales is rejection-dense and the broker vote is a twelve-month marathon, not a sprint.

DO NOT WRITE

Five or six skills with no evidence · "team player" · "strong communicator" with nothing behind it · anything that does not end in a sentence connecting it to a research sales desk.

Cross-cutting rules

- **Front-load every answer.** The first sentence should carry the argument. Assume the reader stops after two lines.

- **One specific fact per paragraph minimum.** Specificity is the only thing that cannot be faked at volume.
- **No fact used twice across the four answers.** You have roughly 1,000 words total; repetition is the most expensive mistake available.
- **Write the answers in this order: Q3, Q2, Q1, Q4.** Do the highest-weighted ones while you are freshest, and let Q1 absorb whatever good material Q2 did not need.

11 · Ammunition sheet

11.1 The numbers worth memorising

Fact	Figure
Redburn founded / Atlantic Equities founded	2003 / 2003
Rothschild & Co minority stake → full ownership → merger → rebrand	Jul 2019 → Dec 2022 → Aug 2023 → Jun 2025
Research analysts / distribution / corporate access professionals	90+ / 43 / 14
Stocks under coverage	c.550+
Institutional clients	c.700
Distribution offices	London, New York, Boston, Paris, Frankfurt, Geneva, Madrid
Group net banking income FY2025 / profit before tax / headcount	€2,986.4m / €714.4m / 4,787 FTE
Global Advisory share of group revenue / bankers / countries	c.60% / c.1,600 / 47
European M&A transactions advised, 2025	334 — 74% more than the busiest bulge bracket; #1 in Europe by deal count
Rothschild independent ECM advisory since 2009	430+ offerings, €390bn+ combined value
Sell ratings: R&Co Redburn vs S&P 500 street-wide	c.9% vs 4.9%
UK asset managers expecting majority client-funded research within 2 years	87%, up from 7% pre-FCA reform
Mid-tier sell-side analysts exiting the market, 2023–26	736
Institutions tracking one-on-one company meetings / analyst visits in the vote	82% / 68%

11.2 The three lines

1 · On independence. "Every scaled independent in European equity research has been bought by a bank — Exane by BNP Paribas, Autonomous and Bernstein into the Société Générale joint venture. Redburn is the one that wasn't, and the reason is that its owner is the one that doesn't have a balance sheet to conflict it with."

2 · On the research product. "The bulge brackets organise research by geography, so Boeing and Airbus get two analysts, two models and two answers. Redburn seats its US and European analysts together in London and covers the industry rather than the region — which is the only way to see a share shift that crosses the Atlantic."

3 · On why it shows up in the output. "The Street runs about 5% Sell ratings. Redburn's book runs closer to 9%, with outright Sells on names like Fiserv and MSCI. That isn't analysts being braver — it's the absence of an underwriting fee they'd be putting at risk."

11.3 Questions to ask them

- How has the shift back toward bundled research payments changed how the desk is measured internally?
- Where does Global Markets Solutions change a salesperson's day — are you now distributing private-market opportunities alongside research?
- How does the global-sector desk structure change the sales conversation versus a regionally-split competitor?
- How quickly does a junior get their own client coverage, and what determines it?
- How does the desk handle the tension between ECM distribution roles and the firm's conflict-free positioning?

11.4 Red flags to avoid

- **Calling it "Redburn Atlantic".** It has been Rothschild & Co Redburn since June 2025. A silent fail.
- **Calling Rothschild & Co an "investment bank".** It is a financial services / advisory group with no lending balance sheet and no proprietary trading. The distinction is the entire point of the firm.
- **Claiming Redburn does no ECM.** It does — as a distributor. The distinction is lead underwriting versus distribution.
- **Treating Sales as the non-technical option.** The training programme opens with accounting, valuation and modelling for a reason.
- **Signalling you want to move to research, the buy side or private equity later.** Graduate offers here go exclusively to summer interns; they are hiring for the seat, not for the CV.
- **Any sentence that would survive a find-and-replace of the firm's name.**

11.5 Application logistics

The 2027 UK Sales Summer Intern Programme (London) is a **10-week internship beginning June 2027**, opening with intensive classroom training in accounting, valuation and modelling before desk placement. Eligibility: second or penultimate year of university, on track for a **2:1 or equivalent**. Applications **opened 19 August 2026** and close on a **rolling basis** — the firm recruits and interviews continuously and explicitly encourages early submission. **Graduate roles are offered exclusively to those who complete the internship successfully**, which makes this the only entry point and raises the stakes on the application itself.

12 · Sources

All material below was consulted directly. Figures from the FY2025 audited consolidated accounts were extracted from the filing itself rather than from secondary coverage.

Company primary sources

Rothschild & Co — Consolidated accounts, December 2025 (audited): rothschildandco.com/siteassets/publications/rothschild_and_co/2025/full_year_results/en_consolidated_accounts_december_2025.pdf

Rothschild & Co — "Announces creation of Global Markets Solutions and rebranding of research arm", 16 June 2025

Rothschild & Co — Global Markets Solutions divisional page

Rothschild & Co — "Invests in independent market leading equities research house, Redburn", July 2019

Rothschild & Co — "Redburn and Atlantic Equities complete their combination to form Redburn Atlantic", August 2023

Rothschild & Co — 2027 UK Redburn Sales Summer Intern Programme, London (role and programme description)

Rothschild & Co — Redburn Review, June 2026 and December 2025

Redburn — "About Redburn" (ideas.redburn.rothschildandco.com)

Rothschild & Co — Equity Advisory / ECM advisory practice pages

Regulatory

FCA — PS24/9, Payment optionality for investment research, July 2024 (in force 1 August 2024)

FCA — PS25/4, extension of payment optionality to pooled funds, May 2025

HM Treasury — Investment Research Review, 2023

Analysis: Skadden, Freshfields, Herbert Smith Freehills Kramer, A&O Shearman, Osborne Clarke, Deloitte Luxembourg, AIMA

Industry and competitor

Société Générale / AllianceBernstein — joint venture announcement and launch of Bernstein

Reuters — "Co-founders of AllianceBernstein's Autonomous research quit ahead of SocGen venture"

BNP Paribas — Exane acquisition and US roll-out announcements

The TRADE — Redburn / Atlantic Equities merger coverage

Extel — 2025 Developed Europe research rankings

Coalition Greenwich; Integrity Research; Harvard Business School — broker vote mechanics and research valuation

FactSet Insight — S&P 500 analyst rating distributions, 2025–2026

IPE; Markets Media; Oliver Wyman — research budgets, rebundling adoption, analyst headcount trends

Deals, ratings and market data

MarketBeat — Rothschild & Co Redburn ratings history and distribution (used as a proxy; see caveat in §5.2)

Medline and Klarna IPO pricing/closing releases and SEC filings (syndicate composition)

GlobalData / Private Banker International — European M&A adviser league tables, 2025 and H1 2026

Euromoney — Awards for Excellence 2025 and 2026

Investing.com, TipRanks, MarketScreener — individual rating actions cited in §8.3

Note on verification. Coverage and headcount figures (90+ analysts, c.550 stocks, c.700 clients) are drawn from company statements made at the time of the 2023 merger and subsequent divisional pages; they are indicative of current scale rather than a point-in-time audited count. The ratings distribution in §5.2 is a third-party proxy, as flagged. Everything sourced to the FY2025 consolidated accounts is audited and exact.